

Regular Meeting
Monday, February 4, 2019
Medford School Committee
Council Chambers

Present: Ms. DiBenedetto, Ms. Kreatz, Ms. Mustone, Mr. Ruseau, Ms. Van der Kloot, Mayor Burke, Superintendent Dr. Edouard-Vincent, Associate Superintendent Diane Caldwell, Assistant Superintendent Kirsteen Patterson, and High School student representative Jasper Su.

Roll Call and Salute the Flag - Mayor Burke called the meeting to order at 7:05pm.

6 - Present

Ms. DiBenedetto

Ms. Kreatz

Ms. Mustone

Mr. Ruseau

Ms. Van der Kloot

Mayor Burke

1 - Absent

Mr. Ruggiero

Approval of Minutes of January 14, 2019 Ms. DiBenedetto - When we have the Committee of the Whole on health I suggest we all attend Zumba together before. Motion to approve offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Kreatz, motion passes.

Approval of Bills/Transfer of Funds - Ms. DiBenedetto asked questions about Amici's Pizza (lunch given to inmates doing repairs) and tuition for special education under circuit breaker. Motion to approve offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Kreatz.

Roll Call Vote: 6 - Affirmative, 1 - Absent, motion passes.

Approval of Payrolls - Motion to approve offered by Mr. Rusea, seconded by Ms. Kreatz.

Roll Call Vote: 6 - Affirmative, 1 - Absent, motion approved.

Revised Secretary Report - Ms. Kreatz - Listed names of people to thank, including one she missed last meeting. Thank you all. Motion to place on file offered by Ms. Kreatz, seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto, motion passes.

Report of Committees: Support Services Sub Committee - Mr. Ruseau - We met in August of last year to update the medication administration policy of the district. We just met at 6:45pm to bring this policy to the whole committee. Some clarifications to busing, times when nursing is not available, and self-administration. Ms. DiBenedetto - School nurse may not consult with the student's physician and get medication ordered without the parent's permission. Toni Wray - When nurses are administering medications, we are able to check with physicians for clarification. Ms. DiBenedetto - It is a major issue. Parental permission for any changes should be required. Changing the prescription without the parents' permission should not happen. This situation occurred. Ms. Wray - I think we should discuss this privately. Ms. DiBenedetto - No, it should be a policy in this document. It never should have happened. Page 2. No parent would want the school nurse to change the prescription without their knowledge. Ms. Wray - This is not appropriate to discuss here. Dr. Edouard-Vincent - We should take it back to subcommittee. Ms. DiBenedetto offered a motion to amend the policy in section e to include that no nurse may change a prescription with a doctor without parental consent. Mr. Ruseau - We don't just create this policy, the school physician has to approve it. Ms. Wray - Yes. Motion to send document back to subcommittee offered by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot, motion passes.

Motion to amend the rules and move Superintendent's updates and comments to after item 4, offered by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. Mustone, motion passes.

Report on Project 351 - Diane Caldwell - Principal Nick Tucci with student Margaret Hines and Principal Michael Downs with student Vishal Romero. Students had wonderful experiences engaging in leadership activities. We will support their leadership endeavors at their schools. Ms. Hines - 8th grade representative from McGlynn Middle School. It was a great blend of hearing from community leaders, meeting other 8th graders from across the state, and taking action through community service. The motto of Project 351 is "Unite, Act, Lead." As long as we are open to conversations, we can find ways to solve problems and take action. The only way to continue in unity is to listen to the ideas of our peers. Mr. Downs - I would like to thank Mr. Levine, social studies teacher who recommended Vishal. Mr. Romero - We heard from Governor Baker and Ayanna Pressley among others. We broke up into groups and went to service sites. We built connections with other students from across the Commonwealth. There is an upcoming spring service project in which we will donate to Cradles to Crayons. Anyone can serve, we are just ambassadors. Mayor Burke - We are so impressed! Motion to accept and place on file offered by Ms. Mustone, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot, motion passes.

Report on Judge Klein's Visit to our Schools - Ms. Caldwell - Judge Klein visited our grade 5 and grade 8 girls. She has been committed to public service since becoming a judge. She grew up here in Medford and her parents still live here and are watching tonight. Her message is that girls

can do anything they want if they work hard. Never give up. Keep focused and move forward toward your dreams. She said it shouldn't matter what you've been through, it matters that you work hard to accomplish your dreams. We have a student from Roberts Elementary, Angela Orellian. She came from Haiti in September 2018. She speaks French, Creole, English, and a little Spanish. Angela - I am a 5th grade student from the Roberts. I was lucky to hear Judge Klein. It was the first time I saw a judge in real life. It was fun to listen to a judge. I learned that sometimes when you get a job there are people who don't like you. People were mean to her. She didn't listen to what they said. She didn't care. If you have a job to do, you do it and don't listen to people who are mean, at home or school, don't let anyone make you sad. Don't let mean people tell you what to do, because you're special. Ms. Van der Kloot - Thank you to all students who came out tonight, it's so nice to hear you. Request to send a thank you note from school committee to Judge Klein. Motion to accept the report and place on file offered by Ms. Kreatz, seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto, motion passes.

Recognition of Big Brothers Big Sisters from Tufts University. Dr. Edouard-Vincent - The students volunteering with Big Brothers Big Sisters are currently at the Columbus Elementary. Thank you.

Recognition of volunteers from Mystic Valley Elder Services. Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Thank you.

Ms. Mustone - Linda can you say a few words? We ask volunteers age 55 and older to volunteer in our schools with reading. We have our volunteers come in and read with students every week. Mayor Burke - Project 351 in action!

Photo taken with all volunteers.

Motion to accept place on file offered by Ms. Kreatz, seconded by Ms. Mustone, motion passes.

Superintendent's Updates and Comments - Priscilla's Pantry - This Wednesday February 6 12-12:30 in Caf 3. All are welcome to attend. Retta Smith, nutrition specialist provided me with the most updated data regarding students. Range of visitors and bags taken between 3 and 34 visitors, 40 bags taken. Word is getting out. Families are learning the food pantry is there as a resource. Thank you to the YMCA and Mr. Hoff, Priscilla's Pantry is named after his late mother.

I was asked to be the keynote speaker at the Medford Martin Luther King Jr. Day event. I spoke about the history of African Americans and my personal history growing up in West Medford, one of the oldest African American communities in the United States. So many people came before me, paving the way so that I, as a first generation Haitian American, am able to realize my

dream of becoming superintendent of schools in Medford, where I grew up. The Patriots had just won the AFC championship, and I thought if we all fight the good fight and don't give up until the end. Recognize that Paulette Van der Kloot, Kathy Kreatz, and Paul Ruseau, as well as the Mayor were there in attendance.

Mustangs are giving strong performances. Tristan Howard of our indoor track team, won the Northeast Conference 55 meter dash in 6.6 seconds. He is the fastest in Massachusetts and New England in this event. He also finished first in long jump and had the fastest 200 meter time in the relay race. He qualified for state championships. Great work Tristan. Our lady Mustang basketball team won the Tufts University cup. The boys basketball team have climbed and won over Everett with a 57-56 score game.

Mr. Maloney would like to invite the school committee to LoConte rink where the Mayor will honor Mr. Welch. He lost his battle with ALS in December. This will be on Saturday, February 15th at 3pm at LoConte rink.

I would like to welcome Chef Ryan Eckles, of Project Bread, to Medford High School. He will be at MHS until the end of March, when he will move to the McGlynn K-8 school. The goal is to make sure our staff gets comfortable preparing his meals. He provides a sample menu item one week and then offers the menu option the next week, so students can try new, healthy foods.

I would like to congratulate our senior Arden Ingersoll, string bass player, who was accepted to the Massachusetts All State orchestra who will perform at Symphony Hall on March 7th. Medford High School freshman cellist Katharine Schmidt, who was accepted to the Massachusetts Music Educators Association Junior Festival. The concert will be held in Wakefield on March 31st.

Our students won the New England Ethics Bowl. It's debate style. Their arguments must be given extemporaneously. Medford defeated all the other schools, some of the most elite across the country. "This win speaks to the calibre of the students here in Medford and the quality of education they have received in medford public schools. It's an affirmation of public education as a whole." - Advisor Eric Enzer.

James and Thelma Connors Scholarship is open, \$3000 each to successful applicants. Applications can be made online, the link is posted on our website and on the blog. Deadline is February 28th.

My team concluded our math learning walks. We visited each of the elementary schools. We did 15 minute snapshots of math instruction. The principals asked that we share our findings so that

teachers can review. Patricia Crain de Galarce of Lesley University said she has already noticed an improvement since our first learning walk in September. We had participation from many of our school leaders, not just from the elementary schools. We have scaled up our work so it can grow in the district.

I attended the winter festival at the McGlynn elementary school hosted by the PTO.

Rising 9th graders, this Wednesday is course selection at the High School from 7pm-8:30pm in the library.

Vaping informational session, What Parents Should Know, Hidden in Plain Sight is this Thursday, February 7th at the McGlynn school, 5pm. Parents/guardians only, during the Valentine's dance.

Friends of Medford Family Network is hosting their Valentine's Day Festival. Prior to that at 10am there will be a meet and greet with the School Committee. Ms. Van der Kloot - We need to move the location from the room where the magician will set up. Motion to accept and place on file offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Kreatz, motion passes.

Recommendation to Approve field trip to New York - Mr. Tucci - 60 students from the McGlynn Middle School are planning to attend. Scholarships are offered for financially needy families. Special thanks to Sherry Flint for setting this trip up. Mr. Downs - Special thanks to Michael DiClemente and to our PTO, who are behind our scholarships we are able to give this year. Special thanks to members of our community who wished to remain anonymous but who donated to assist some students in paying for the trip. Mr. DiClemente - all kids who reached out for scholarships were given a scholarship. We reached out to the PTO. Also in an effort to make the trip as equitable as possible, we are all going to all the same places, at different times, museums and shows are all the same. 124 Andrews students are currently signed up. We had to extend to three buses because we did not want to turn any students away. Mr. Ruseau - How many students could potentially go from the McGlynn? How many students are eligible? Mr. Tucci - All the 8th grade students, 160 about, 60 have signed up as of now. Mr. Downs - We have 165 8th graders and 145 are now going. Mr. Ruseau - Why are the numbers so different? Mr. DiClemente - We generally get about 50% of students so this year is a real outlier at the Andrews. Mr. Tucci - This number is consistent with past years' participation rates. Ms. DiBenedetto - What are the plans for the small group that will be left at the Andrews? Mr. Downs - We are still finalizing exactly who the chaperones are going to be. We have to find coverage for all chaperones. If we can find a chaperone, we are planning to coordinate a day trip with the students who will still be in Medford. Ms. DiBenedetto - I didn't see insurance listed on this form. We had to cancel a trip once. Mr. Tucci - The company we are working with now has

insurance as part of the trip. We can share that with you. Ms. DiBenedetto - If the School Committee decides to cancel the trip for any reason, will parents receive all their money back? It is our policy that they need to have insurance coverage. Mr. Tucci - We can get back to you. Mr. Ruseau - Is it possible to survey the students who are not going to find out why? Is it that we need to find money? Do the kids just not want to go? Do parents not want them to go? I want to ensure it's not money. I don't want parents to not send their kids because they can't afford it. Mr. Su - When I went I think there were 70 kids who went my year. The consensus was that it was a cool trip. Some people just didn't want to go. Some people had sports, there was a big birthday party. It wasn't that kids couldn't go, but they didn't want to. This is my feedback from my year, 4 years ago. Mr. DiClemente - I and Ms. Flint have made perfectly clear that if students tell us they want to go we will make sure they can go. I have let them know there is money available. Kids took that opportunity. A lot of the time parents don't want their kids to go, other obligations, fear of travel. Motion to approve offered by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Mr. Ruseau.

Roll Call Vote - 6 Affirmative, 1 Absent, motion passes.

Recommendation to Approve Field Trip to University of Rhode Island - Mr. Tucci - Science field trip to get excited about learning and spend time outside. \$180-\$200 per student with scholarships available to needy students. May 6th - May 7th, that is a Monday - Tuesday. Special thanks to Patty Haas and Angela Bellini who put a tremendous amount of work into this trip. Ms. Van der Kloot - Please keep us abreast of fundraisers so that we may participate. Mr. Ruseau - Do we require the transportation methods to have seat belts? Mr. Tucci - No, not our policy right now. It's coach buses. Eastern bus does not have seat belts. Motion to approve by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot.

Roll call vote - 6 Affirmative, 1 Absent, motion approved.

Recommendation to Approve Donation to Roberts Elementary School - Kirk Johnson - Ms. Christina Dimare donated headsets to our school. Motion to approve by Ms. Kreatz, seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto, motion passes.

Recommendation to Approve Donation from Impact Church - Kirsteen Patterson - The church would like to donate to improve the lighting at McGlynn. This will benefit the students. We are requesting quotes from different vendors, I've received 2 so far and am waiting for the 3rd. We are very fortunate to receive this. Motion to approve by Ms Kreatz, seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto.

Roll Call Vote - 6 - Affirmative, 1 Absent, motion approved.

Report on Fundraising Organizations - Emily Lazzaro - There is an addendum to this report on your desks, it was being updated as of today. In future years a form will be sent out in October and it will be reported on in February to the School Committee. Ms. DiBenedetto - There are lots of non-PTO 501(c)3s not listed here. We require that they register with us in order to raise money in the name of Medford Public Schools. Have you reached out to those groups? Ms. Lazzaro - I reached out to every organization I was able to find based on the Attorney General's Office or word of mouth. If they are a genuine 501(c)3 they are required to report their financials to the Attorney General's Office. This is an announcement that if any organization is raising money that they please reach out to me, my contact information is on the report. Ms. DiBenedetto - There was an online form. Ms. Lazzaro - Yes, the original form was owned by someone outside our organization so I am recreating the form for future years. It was sent out and that information was collected. Ms. DiBenedetto - What about organizations that are raising money that are not 501(c)3s? Ms. Patterson - Many of these organizations raise money and the funds go through Student Activity accounts. Ms. Petrone - I have 10 sport teams that send me deposits. The Secretary of the School Committee will see those checks. If I have questions I take them to Kirsteen. Anyone who has ever signed the bills would see those. Ms. DiBenedetto - If a coach decides to run a camp, does that go through Community Schools? I see it on Facebook all the time. Does it go through the schools? Ms. Patterson - It's dependent on how it's booked. If it's truly a camp, it's through Community Schools. If it was a camp the team was running for their youth, that could be a student activity. Ms. DiBenedetto - When I see "you can pay at the door" in cash, who does it go through? Ms. Patterson - It depends what organization is running the event. If it's a school event it goes through student activities, if it's an independent 501(c)3 it goes through their tax IDs. Ms. DiBenedetto - People were charging students for coaching and sending it through a Friends Of account. The goal is to fix that. Ms. Patterson - We had an audit of student activities and we've demonstrated the validity of it. If there is something that comes through we don't know about, I am happy to answer to a particular item. I don't know of a situation that has happened like that, but we are taking precautions to safeguard funds. Ms. DiBenedetto - Maybe we need a list of activities groups, and we can see how it works annually. I want to tighten it up. Ms. Patterson - We have tightened it up. I can provide a list of Student Activity accounts. Ms. DiBenedetto - I think this is a Committee of the Whole to get policies in place. Ms. Patterson - We do have policies, we have clarified that, last year. We developed brand new checking and savings accounts for all Student Activities and got it approved by School Committee. Mr. Ruseau - Big Brothers Big Sisters, Kiwanis, large organizations that raise money in and spend their money in Medford. We don't know how much they spent on us or collected in our name. Where does that money come from and where does it go? Mayor Burke - They have searched 501(c)3s for Medford. Mr. Ruseau - We shouldn't allow a donation to our schools from an organization if we don't know where it came from. Ms. Patterson - If a large organization like the Red Cross made a donation to Medford, we accept them and share it here

and get a vote for approval and acceptance. The large corporations are not fundraising on behalf of Medford Public Schools. If they make a donation we vote to accept that donation. Mr. Ruseau - As long as they are not fundraising in our name. Ms. Patterson - The law indicates you have to present your source and use, if the Red Cross was fundraising they do so on a national or global scale and they decide where to send their resources. It would be delivered here for acceptance. Ms. Van der Kloot - Medford Field of Dreams is listed here. That one is not on the chart. Ms. Lazzaro - This is an ongoing document. If anyone knows that an organization is connected to the schools, we can follow up on it, if we know. Ms. Van der Kloot - I had expected a longer list. It would make sense for us to have a list of the organizations that are not 501(c)3s. Ms. Petrone - We have over 60 student activity accounts for the high school. Curtis Tufts is part of Medford High student activities. Ms. DiBenedetto - When we get the activity accounts, we need contact information, the same information we are getting for the PTOs and non-profits. Mayor Burke - It's our bank accounts. Ms. DiBenedetto - What if they're not a 501(c)3 and not a student activity? Mayor Burke - We wouldn't know unless they tell us. If you know of someone, tell Ms. Lazzaro. Ms. DiBenedetto - Enforcement is our next issue, to make sure all those groups are self-reporting because it's mandated by the School Committee. Motion to accept and place on file offered by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Ms. Kreatz, motion passes.

Condolences. All rise for a moment of silence.

School Committee Resolution, read by Mayor Burke. Senate docket number is 101. We should all be advocating for this and fighting the fight. House representative offered a bill as well, three bills in the legislature now. Mr. Ruseau - Thank you for including this. \$4 million, that's \$4 million every year we are not seeing. Every facility issue, every year it adds up to a lot. This would quickly make a difference for us. We will send this to the Governor and our State delegation. Mayor Burke - Every few weeks we should look at this and blast it out to parents, teachers, everyone. Mr. Ruseau - It impacts all Medford taxpayers. It ends up being that the city has to give the schools more because we get less from the state. Everybody stands to benefit from this. Ms. DiBenedetto - I think this is an opportunity to work collaboratively with the city council. Can we request that they send a similar letter to the Governor. Can we send a letter to the city council. We can go and speak. Motion to accept resolution by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot.

Roll Call Vote: 6 - Affirmative, 1 - Absent, motion passes.

Motion to adjourn by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. Mustone at 8:54pm.